

Career Path AI - Complete Setup Guide

1. Install Python

Go to <https://www.python.org/downloads/>. Download Python. During installation, CHECK the box 'Add Python to PATH', then click Install Now.

2. Extract Project

Right-click the ZIP file -> Extract All. Open the extracted folder.

3. Open in VS Code

Open VS Code -> File -> Open Folder -> Select the extracted Career_Path_AI folder.

4. Open Terminal

In VS Code click Terminal -> New Terminal. If the terminal starts with 'PS', click the ▼ next to the + button and choose 'Command Prompt'. You should now see a prompt like C:\Users\... instead of PS C:\Users\...

5. Create Virtual Environment

Run:

```
python -m venv venv
```

6. Activate

In Command Prompt run:

```
venv\Scripts\activate.bat
```

If (venv) appears before the path, activation worked.

7. Install Packages

Run:

```
pip install -r requirements.txt
```

Then run:

```
pip install python-dotenv
```

8. Create OpenAI API Key

Go to <https://platform.openai.com/>. Sign in. Click your profile -> View API keys OR open <https://platform.openai.com/api-keys>. Click 'Create new secret key'. Copy the key (starts with sk-...).

Note: API usage requires a billing-enabled OpenAI API account.

9. Create .env File

In the project folder create a new file named exactly .env (not .env.txt). Add:

```
OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-your-new-key
```

10. Edit app.py

At the top of app.py ensure these lines exist:

```
from dotenv import load_dotenv  
load_dotenv()
```

11. Run

Run:

```
streamlit run app.py
```

12. Browser

Open <http://localhost:8501> if it doesn't open automatically.

Troubleshooting

Python not found: reinstall Python with Add to PATH checked.

PowerShell script error: switch terminal to Command Prompt.

streamlit not recognized: activate venv again or run `python -m streamlit run app.py`.

OpenAI API key not found: check `.env` name, API key, and `load_dotenv()`.